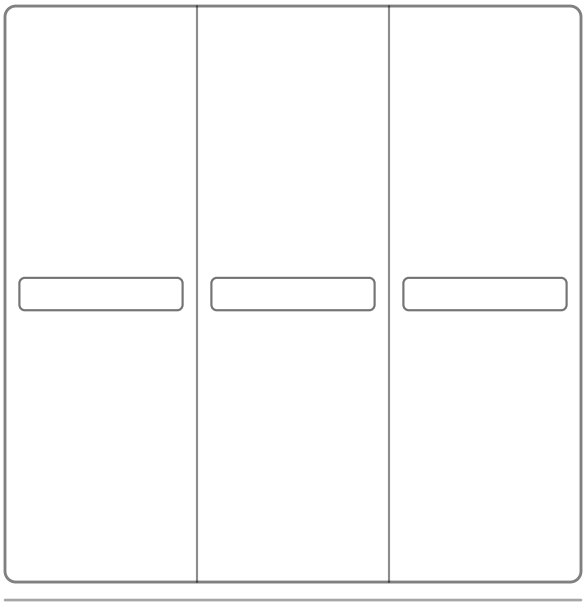
Start, Stop, Continue

3 Columns: Start, Stop, Continue · 45–60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Operational drift during standard bi-weekly sprint cadences; teams requiring a direct, low-friction mechanism to discard counterproductive habits and institutionalize emerging engineering practices.

R01

Start, Stop, Continue

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite Kerth's Prime Directive verbatim; one-word check-in.
2. Gather data (15m): silent notes; Start missing, Stop wasteful, Continue working.
3. Generate insights (15m): cluster themes; three dot votes each on Stop and Start.
4. Decide (20m): top-voted items become bounded experiments via the action converter.
5. Close (5m): owners and dates confirmed; rate the session 1–5.

THE MOVE

Every Stop item names the constraint that replaces it: two required approvals, one owner, a date.

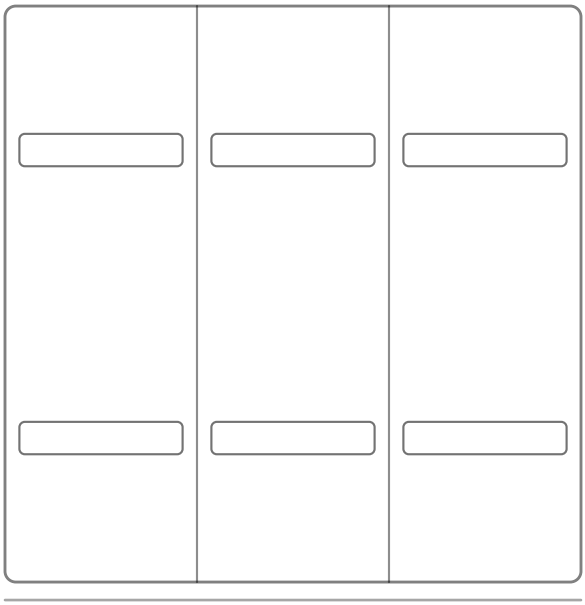
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the phases and minutes follow the written sequence in the source.

The source names no originator.

Mad, Sad, Glad

3 Columns: Mad, Sad, Glad · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Sprints characterized by emotional volatility, interpersonal friction, or organizational friction that technical burndown charts fail to capture.

R02

Mad, Sad, Glad

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive; emotion is a system signal.
2. Gather data (15m): silent notes in Mad, Sad, Glad; colour by column.
3. Generate insights (20m): read Mad, then Sad, then Glad; ask what conditions produced each.
4. Decide (15m): one Mad or Sad cause becomes one structural mitigation.
5. Close (5m): appreciations from the Glad column, each naming a person.

THE MOVE

'Mad about flaky staging' becomes isolate staging databases and script a nightly refresh; one owner, one date.

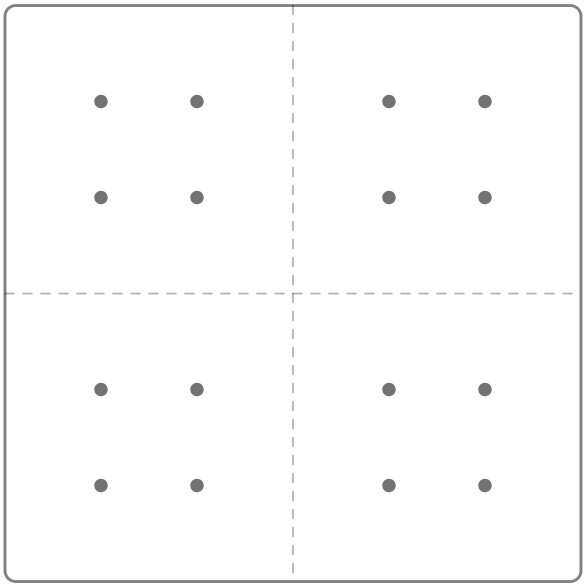
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the phases and minutes follow the written sequence in the source.

The source names no originator.

4Ls (Loved, Learned, Loathed, Longed For)

4 Quadrants: Loved, Learned, Loathed, Longed For · 60–75 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Milestone or sprint reviews within engineering teams requiring a balanced evaluation of intellectual growth, product value, and operational friction.

R03

4Ls (Loved, Learned, Loathed, Longed For)

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive; Loathed targets tooling, never a colleague.
2. Gather data (20m): two notes each into Loved, Learned, Loathed, Longed For.
3. Generate insights (20m): pair each Loathed with the Longed For that removes it.
4. Decide (20m): the strongest pairs become backlog experiments with owners.
5. Close (5m): name what the Learned notes give back.

THE MOVE

Loathed manual tagging plus Longed For automated releases becomes one release action.

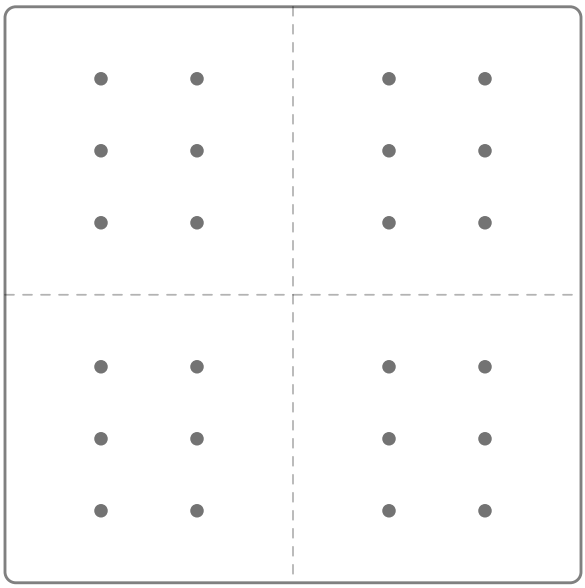
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the phases and minutes follow the written sequence in the source.

The source names no originator.

KALM (Keep, Add, Less, More)

4 Quadrants: Keep, Add, Less, More · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Teams experiencing process fatigue that need to modulate the intensity of existing activities rather than reinvent their workflow.

R04

KALM (Keep, Add, Less, More)

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive; this is tuning, not rebuilding.
2. Gather data (15m): sort current practices into Keep, Add, Less, More.
3. Generate insights (20m): name the capacity Less frees and where More spends it.
4. Decide (15m): put a number on every Less commitment; one owner each.
5. Close (5m): confirm the new agreements in one sentence each.

THE MOVE

Less time in standup becomes a hard ten-minute timer with status moved to the channel: owner and start date.

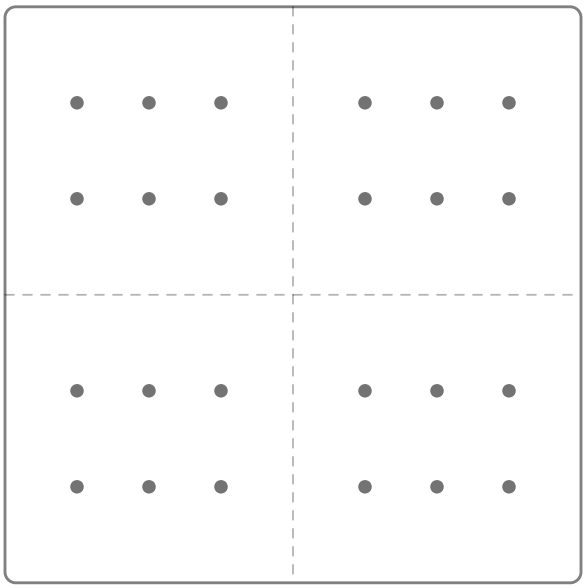
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the phases and minutes follow the written sequence in the source.

The source names no originator.

Glad, Sad, Mad + Afraid

4 Quadrants: Glad, Sad, Mad, Afraid · 60–90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Impending corporate reorganizations, high-stakes platform migrations, or strategic pivots where latent psychological anxiety must be addressed directly.

R05

Glad, Sad, Mad + Afraid

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; fear is a predictable response to change.
2. Gather data (15m): anonymous notes into Glad, Sad, Mad, Afraid.
3. Generate insights (25m): split Afraid into verified risk and unverified rumour.
4. Decide (20m): write the questions leadership must answer; name who asks.
5. Close (5m): close on shared agency, naming what the team still controls.

THE MOVE

Afraid notes become information-seeking tickets: a question, an owner, and a deadline for leadership's answer.

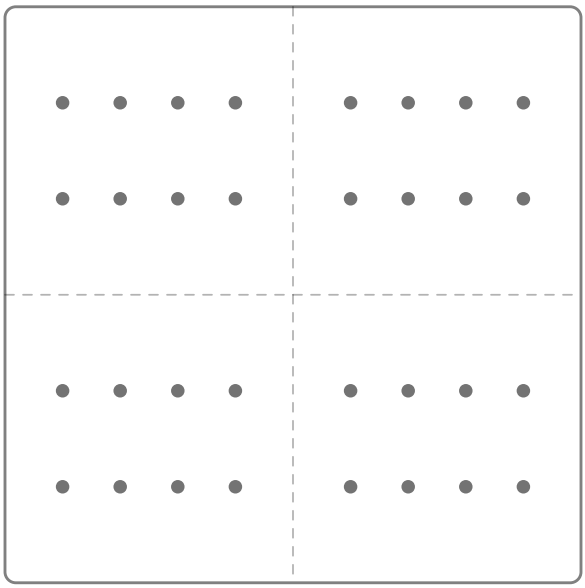
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the phases and minutes follow the written sequence in the source.

The source names no originator.

DAKI (Drop, Add, Keep, Improve)

4 Quadrants: Drop, Add, Keep, Improve · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Teams overwhelmed by operational baggage, meeting sprawl, redundant documentation, or outdated tooling.

R06

DAKI (Drop, Add, Keep, Improve)

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive; dropping a process is not criticising its author.
2. Gather data (15m): silent notes into Drop, Add, Keep, Improve.
3. Generate insights (20m): clear Drop first, naming the capacity it returns.
4. Decide (15m): deprecate one practice and spend its capacity on one addition.
5. Close (5m): record what was dropped, so it is not quietly reintroduced.

THE MOVE

The Dropped practice gets a deprecation date and a replacement; its freed capacity funds the chosen Add.

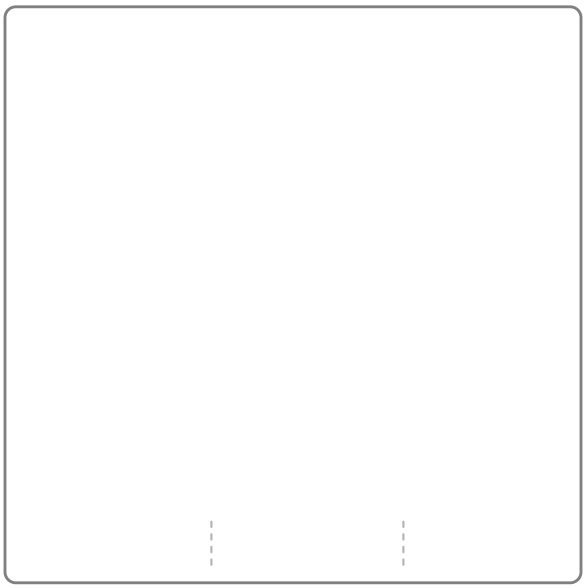
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.

The Three Little Pigs

3 Zones: House of Straw, Sticks, Bricks · 60–90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Architectural debt retrospectives, stabilization sprints, or infrastructure reviews following high-traffic incidents.

R07

The Three Little Pigs

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; Straw was a compromise, not bad craft.
2. Gather data (20m): list systems under Straw, Sticks, Bricks with evidence.
3. Generate insights (25m): map the path from Straw to Sticks to Bricks.
4. Decide (20m): pick one Straw component; give its promotion a coverage gate.
5. Close (5m): name the Brick the next incident would rely on.

THE MOVE

A Straw component becomes a P0 refactoring spike with a test-coverage gate before it carries production traffic.

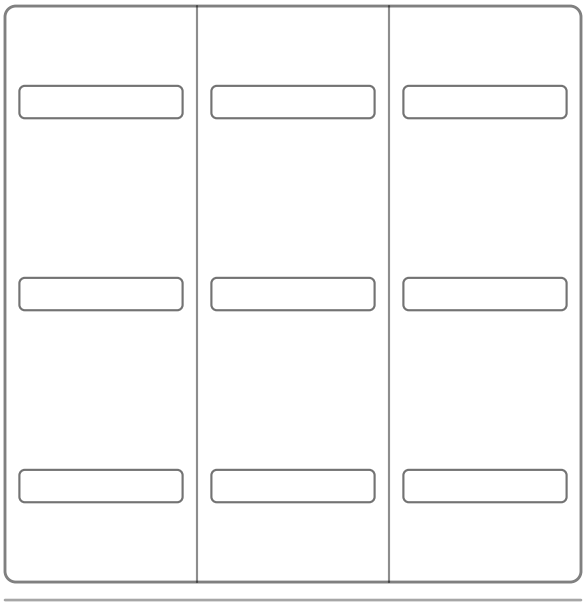
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.

Rose, Thorn, Bud

3 Columns: Rose, Thorn, Bud · 45–60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Product discovery sprints, UI/UX iterations, and collaborative design-engineering syncs.

R08

Rose, Thorn, Bud

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive before any note is written.
2. Gather data (15m): silent notes into Rose, Thorn, Bud.
3. Generate insights (15m): turn the strongest Buds into spike candidates.
4. Decide (10m): timebox one Bud as a discovery ticket with an owner.
5. Close (5m): name one Thorn the next sprint will remove.

THE MOVE

The chosen Bud becomes a timeboxed discovery ticket; the Thorn it would remove is written on the ticket so the two stay linked.

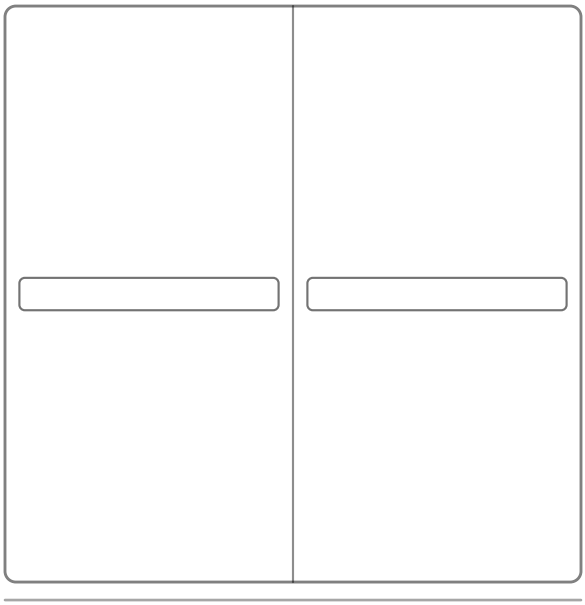
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.

Plus / Delta (+ / Δ)

2 Columns: Plus (+), Delta (Δ) · 30–45 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

High-cadence micro-retrospectives, daily debriefs during release crunches, or rapid 30-minute timeboxed checkpoints.

R09

Plus / Delta (+ / Δ)

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (3m): show the Prime Directive; one sentence on the sprint's aim.
2. Gather data (7m): silent notes into Plus and Delta.
3. Generate insights (10m): merge duplicates; keep every Delta precise.
4. Decide (8m): select exactly one Delta for the next iteration.
5. Close (2m): read the chosen Delta back; name its owner.

THE MOVE

Exactly one Delta enters the next sprint as a backlog item with an owner and a review date; the Plus notes are read aloud, not ticketed.

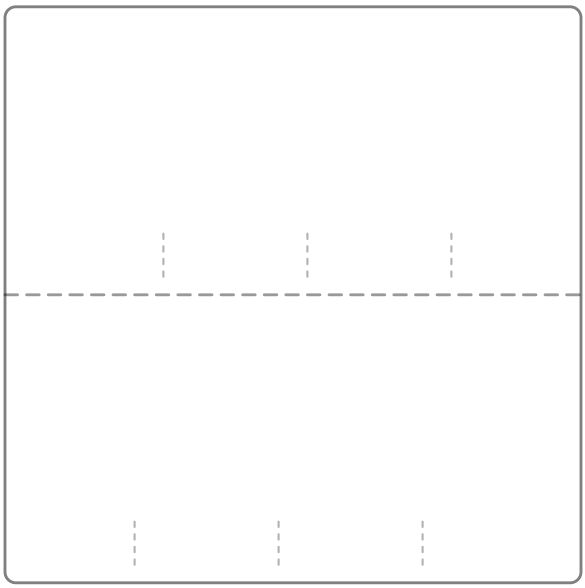
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the phases and minutes follow the written sequence in the source.

The source names no originator.

The Sailboat

4 Zones: Island, Wind, Anchors, Rocks · 60–90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Teams struggling to decouple their aspirational product goals from current technical drag, organizational dependencies, and impending environmental risks.

R10

The Sailboat

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive; name the target Island.
2. Gather data (20m): five minutes per zone: Wind, Anchors, Rocks, then the Island.
3. Generate insights (20m): cluster notes; dot-vote the heaviest Anchors and Rocks.
4. Decide (15m): sever one Anchor before adding Wind; name its owner.
5. Close (5m): affirm navigation capability and capture the ROTI.

THE MOVE

An Anchor becomes a systemic initiative: parallel CI under 15 minutes instead of 90; owner, date.

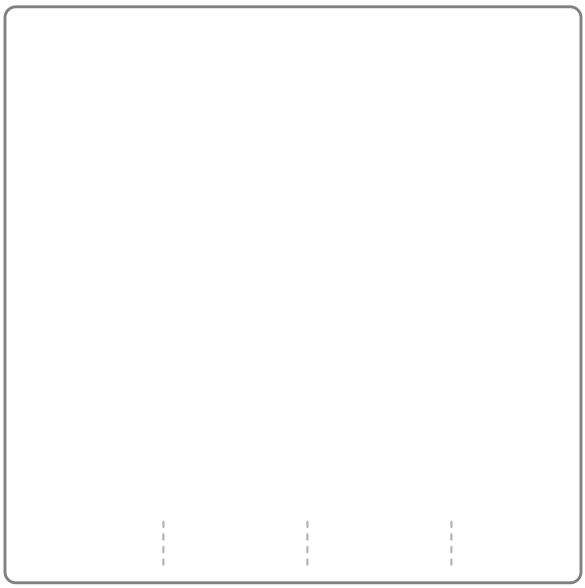
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the phases and minutes follow the written sequence in the source.

Source: Luke Hohmann (2006). *Innovation Games.* Addison-Wesley.

Speed Car / Race Car

4 Zones: Engine, Parachute, Pit Stop, Hazards · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Teams experiencing velocity bottlenecks, deployment throttling, or code review stalls.

R11

Speed Car / Race Car

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive before inspecting the Parachute.
2. Gather data (15m): notes into Engine, Parachute, Pit Stop, Hazards.
3. Generate insights (20m): focus on Pit Stop; name the maintenance that prevents burnout.
4. Decide (15m): one Pit Stop item becomes an infrastructure ticket with a date.
5. Close (5m): name the Engine gain the next sprint should protect.

THE MOVE

A Pit Stop card becomes infrastructure maintenance: a ticket, an owner, and a date before the next release.

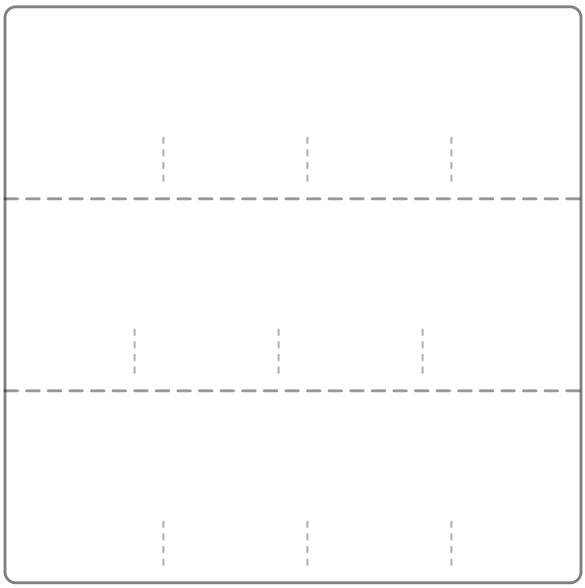
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.

Hot Air Balloon

4 Zones: Hot Air, Sandbags, Storm Clouds, Skies · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Low-morale sprints where the team needs to acknowledge positive contributions while systematically identifying operational baggage.

R12

Hot Air Balloon

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive; lift and ballast are both data.
2. Gather data (15m): notes into Hot Air, Sandbags, Storm Clouds, Skies.
3. Generate insights (20m): compare the lift of Hot Air against the drag of Sandbags.
4. Decide (15m): unclip one Sandbag; name the task or tool it retires.
5. Close (5m): state the altitude the team expects next sprint.

THE MOVE

A Sandbag becomes a formal deprecation: the task or tool is retired with a date and a replacement.

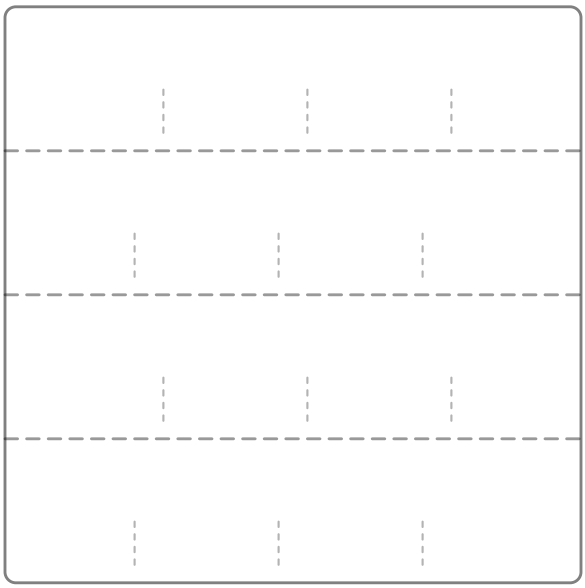
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.

Mountain Trek

4 Zones: Summit, Basecamp, Crevasses, Gear · 90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Multi-sprint delivery campaigns, quarterly releases, or major infrastructural initiatives.

R13

Mountain Trek

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; agree the Summit's completion criteria.
2. Gather data (25m): list delivered architecture, unmonitored risks, and gear in use.
3. Generate insights (25m): trace Basecamp to Summit; name the Crevasses on that path.
4. Decide (20m): one Crevasse gets a risk-mitigation spike with an owner.
5. Close (10m): name the Gear the next leg depends on.

THE MOVE

A Crevasse becomes a risk-mitigation spike on the active backlog; crossing it without the named Gear is not allowed.

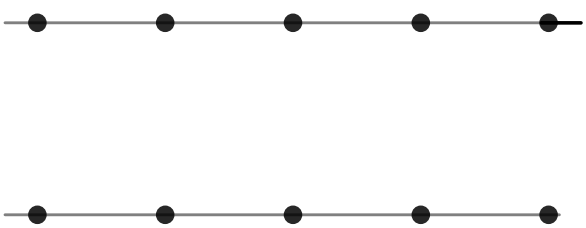
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.

The Hero’s Journey

5 Stages: Ordinary World, Call, Abyss, Transformation, Elixir · 90–120 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Post-release reviews following demanding delivery crunches or major technical recoveries.

R14

The Hero’s Journey

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive.
2. Gather data (20m): walk the five stations in order; one note per station.
3. Generate insights (30m): harvest the Elixir; name the permanent capability.
4. Decide (25m): turn the Elixir into a runbook or decision record, with an owner.
5. Close (15m): name who supported whom at the worst point.

THE MOVE

The Elixir becomes an artifact — runbook, decision record, or test — committed with an owner.

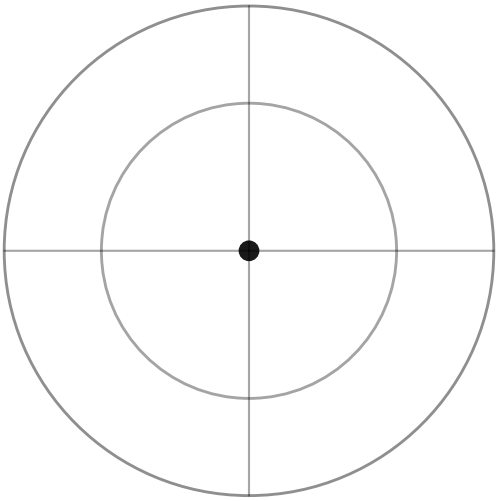
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

Source: Joseph Campbell (1949). *The Hero with a Thousand Faces.*

Space Mission / Rocket

4 Zones: Thrusters, Gravity, Asteroids, Target Orbit · 60–90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

High-risk exploratory initiatives, zero-to-one product development, or deep R&D milestones.

R15

Space Mission / Rocket

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive; name the Target Orbit.
2. Gather data (20m): notes into Thrusters, Gravity, Asteroids, Target Orbit.
3. Generate insights (25m): test whether Thrusters outpace organizational Gravity.
4. Decide (20m): one Gravity item becomes a waiver request with an owner.
5. Close (10m): name the first asteroid the next sprint routes around.

THE MOVE

A Gravity item becomes a waiver request to leadership: the rule, its cost, and the experiment.

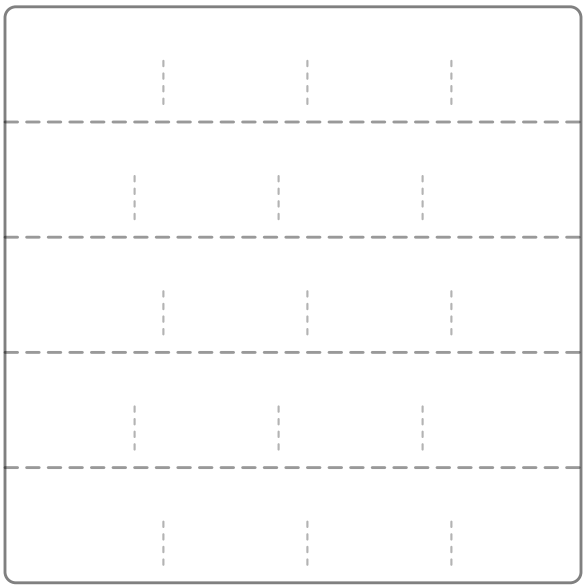
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.

Island Castaway

4 Zones: Shelter, Fresh Spring, Predators, SOS Flare · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Sudden loss of team capacity, extreme resource starvation, or emergency operational survival mode.

R16

Island Castaway

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive; name what must survive.
2. Gather data (15m): notes into Shelter, Fresh Spring, Predators, SOS Flare.
3. Generate insights (20m): rank non-essential work against the Shelter's needs.
4. Decide (15m): cut one non-essential commitment; name what the cut protects.
5. Close (5m): confirm the SOS Flare and who fires it.

THE MOVE

An SOS Flare becomes an executive escalation ticket, sent within two hours of the session, with a named owner.

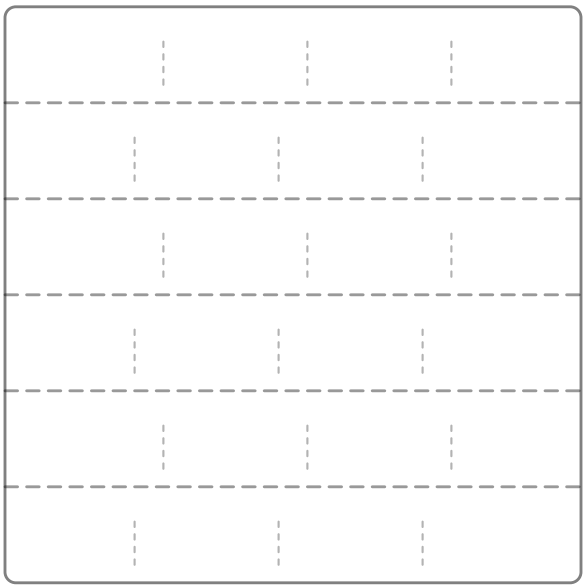
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.

The Submarine

4 Zones: Propulsion, Ballast Tanks, Hull Breaches, Periscope · 60–90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Accumulated technical debt, creeping memory leaks, latent architectural fragility, or mounting compliance risks.

R17

The Submarine

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive; pressure is a system property.
2. Gather data (20m): notes into Propulsion, Ballast Tanks, Hull Breaches, Periscope.
3. Generate insights (25m): quantify the pressure each Hull Breach can take.
4. Decide (20m): one Hull Breach becomes a P0 remediation ticket with a date.
5. Close (10m): name what the Periscope shows the next sprint will demand.

THE MOVE

A Hull Breach enters the next sprint as P0 technical-debt remediation, with a fix and a test that would have caught it.

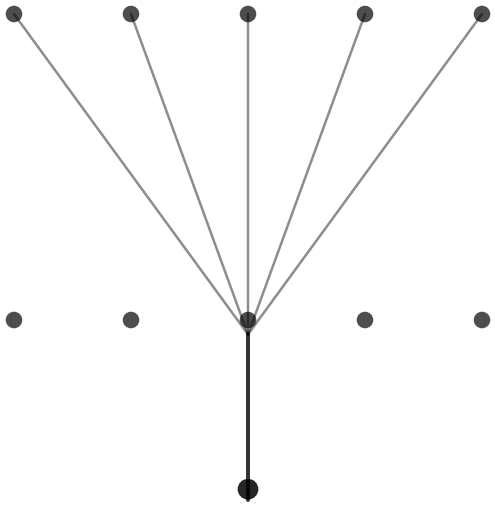
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.

The Living Tree

5 Zones: Roots/Soil, Trunk, Leaves, Rotten Branches, Fruit · 90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Annual retrospectives, long-term engineering health reviews, or major team structural reorganizations.

R18

The Living Tree

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; roots first, canopy second.
2. Gather data (20m): notes into Roots, Trunk, Leaves, Fruit, Rotten Branches.
3. Generate insights (25m): test whether the Roots can sustain the canopy.
4. Decide (20m): one Rotten Branch gets decommissioning, not a redesign.
5. Close (15m): name the Fruit the team would protect through the next cut.

THE MOVE

A Rotten Branch becomes a decommissioning ticket: the dead route, flag, or process is removed.

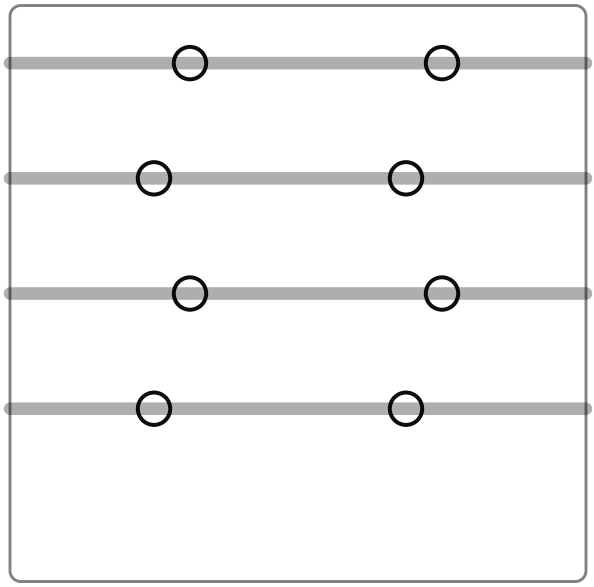
PROVENANCE

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The source names no originator.

Blameless Post-Mortem Arc

4 Bands: Chronology, System Context, Latent Weaknesses, Repair · 90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Production service interruptions (SEV-1/SEV-2 outages, data corruption, security breaches).

R19

Blameless Post-Mortem Arc

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; ban should have and failed to.
2. Gather data (25m): build the UTC timeline from traces, git logs, and chat.
3. Generate insights (30m): ask why each action made sense to responders then.
4. Decide (20m): design defense-in-depth mitigations, not warnings.
5. Close (5m): thank responders; schedule publication of the report.

THE MOVE

Automate the barrier, not the warning: a canary checks cache hits above 95% before traffic.

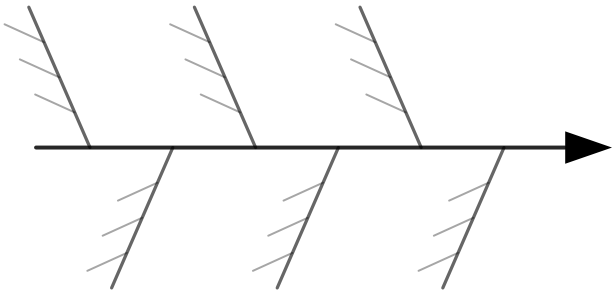
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the phases and minutes follow the written sequence in the source.

Source: John Allspaw (2012). *Blameless PostMortems and a Just Culture.*

5 Whys Fishbone

Ishikawa Spine & 6M Ribs: Machine, Method, Material, Mortal, Measurement, Nature · 60–90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Chronic, recurring technical defects across sprint cycles that resist simple operational triage.

R20

5 Whys Fishbone

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; Mortal covers fatigue and training, not blame.
2. Gather data (25m): six 6M ribs, failure at head.
3. Generate insights (25m): five whys down every rib.
4. Decide (15m): deepest verified node becomes a ticket.
5. Close (5m): name the rib with the least evidence.

THE MOVE

Deepest verified node per rib becomes a mitigation ticket; unverified chains stay open.

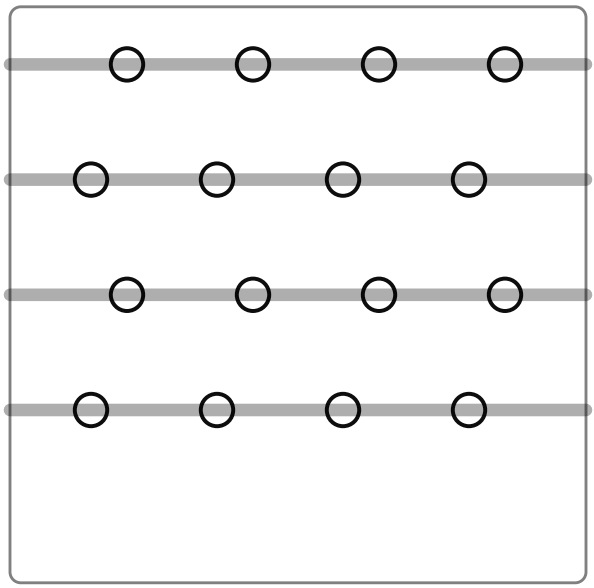
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

Source: Kaoru Ishikawa (1968). *Guide to Quality Control.* Asian Productivity Organization.
Source: Taiichi Ohno (1988). *Toyota Production System: Beyond Large-Scale Production.* Productivity Press.

Swiss Cheese Safety Model

4 Slices: Organization, Supervision, Preconditions, Defenses · 90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Cascading systemic outages where multiple independent defensive barriers failed simultaneously.

R21

Swiss Cheese Safety Model

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; safety is emergent, not individual.
2. Gather data (25m): trace the failure through the four slices; mark each hole.
3. Generate insights (25m): find where holes aligned; name the missing barrier.
4. Decide (20m): add a new slice or shrink holes in at least two layers.
5. Close (10m): name the barrier the next incident tests.

THE MOVE

An intervention adds a new defensive slice or reduces the holes in two layers; one layer alone is a patch, not a barrier.

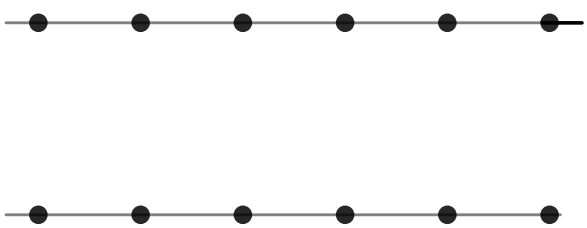
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

Source: James Reason (1990). *Human Error.* Cambridge University Press.

Timeline & Drift Analysis

Dual-Axis Chronology: Work as Imagined vs. Work as Done · 75–90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Operational failures where engineering practices deviated significantly from written operating procedures.

R22

Timeline & Drift Analysis

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; drift is a policy signal, not defiance.
2. Gather data (25m): build both tracks: work as imagined and work as done.
3. Generate insights (25m): find the first divergence; explain why it was rational.
4. Decide (20m): update the procedure or automate the step that forced the drift.
5. Close (10m): name the runbook on-call should not need to bypass.

THE MOVE

The chosen divergence becomes a corrected procedure or an automated step; the workaround is deleted.

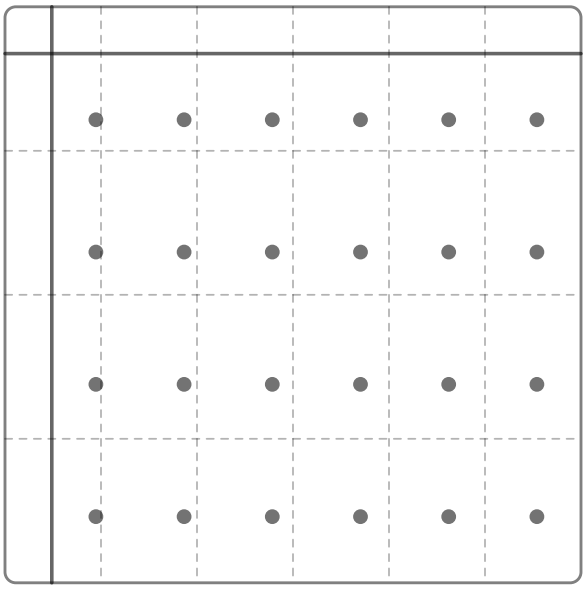
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.

FMEA Diagnostic

Matrix: Failure Mode, Severity, Occurrence, Detection, RPN · 90–120 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Pre-launch architectural reviews, critical database schema migrations, or infrastructure cutovers.

R23

FMEA Diagnostic

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; scoring is about the system.
2. Gather data (30m): list component failure modes and their potential impact.
3. Generate insights (30m): score Severity, Occurrence and Detection from 1 to 10.
4. Decide (35m): compute RPN; any mode above 120 gets a pre-launch ticket.
5. Close (15m): name the highest-RPN mode and its owner.

THE MOVE

A mode with RPN above 120 generates a mandatory pre-launch ticket with an owner.

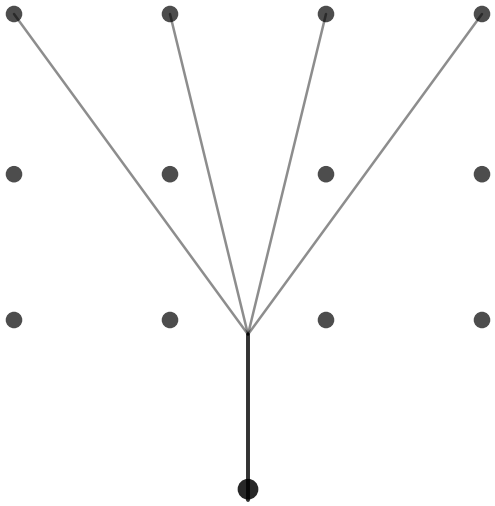
PROVENANCE

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The source names no originator.

Fault Tree Analysis

Top-down Tree: Catastrophic Event, Logic Gates (AND/OR), Basic Faults · 90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Complex microservice outages involving race conditions, deadlocks, or distributed cascading dependencies.

R24

Fault Tree Analysis

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; the tree maps conditions, not culprits.
2. Gather data (25m): put the catastrophic event at the top; branch downward.
3. Generate insights (25m): mark each gate AND or OR; name the single points.
4. Decide (20m): redesign one OR gate into an AND with independent fallback.
5. Close (10m): name the leaf the tree could not rule out.

THE MOVE

A single-point OR gate becomes an AND architecture with an independent fallback, tested before the next release.

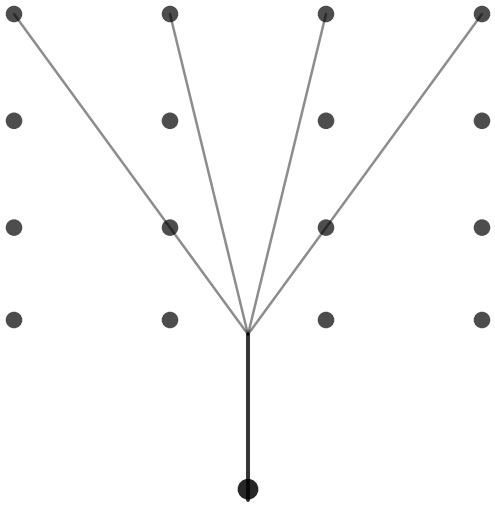
PROVENANCE

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HFACS Retrospective

4 Tiers: Unsafe Acts, Preconditions, Supervisory, Organizational · 90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Incidents characterized by on-call cognitive fatigue, misread alerts, or communication breakdowns during emergency response.

R25

HFACS Retrospective

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; start from the act, not the actor.
2. Gather data (25m): place the unsafe act, then its preconditions.
3. Generate insights (25m): trace upward into supervisory and organizational factors.
4. Decide (20m): one human-centred policy change with an owner and a date.
5. Close (10m): name the handoff the next on-call needs.

THE MOVE

A human factor becomes a policy: protected rest after a severe overnight incident.

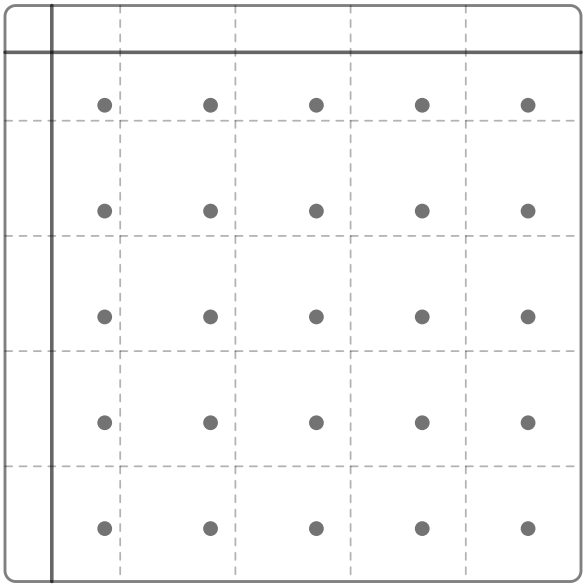
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

Source: Scott Shappell & Douglas Wiegmann (2003). *A Human Error Approach to Aviation Accident Analysis.* Ashgate.

Contributory Factor Matrix

5 Swimlanes: Individual, Team, Task, Workplace, Institutional · 90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Complex outages cutting across organizational boundaries (e.g., third-party APIs, external vendors, corporate security mandates).

R26

Contributory Factor Matrix

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; every lane includes external pressure.
2. Gather data (25m): map incident data across all five swimlanes at once.
3. Generate insights (25m): show how vendor constraints amplified local errors.
4. Decide (20m): one upstream dependency gets an SLO and a contract test.
5. Close (10m): name the lane the team cannot change alone.

THE MOVE

An upstream dependency gets a service-level objective and a contract test; the workaround retires when both pass.

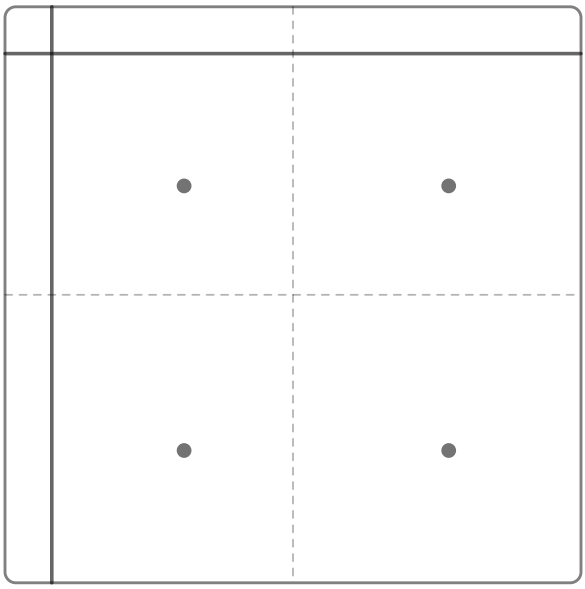
PROVENANCE

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The source names no originator.

Incident Matrix (4-Box)

2x2 Matrix: Internal/External vs. Expected/ Unexpected · 45 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Low-severity incidents (SEV-3/SEV-4); recurring bug triage sessions requiring rapid classification.

R27

Incident Matrix (4-Box)

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive; classification is not blame.
2. Gather data (10m): place each defect on the 2x2 matrix.
3. Generate insights (15m): focus on Internal/Unexpected; name the blind spot.
4. Decide (10m): one Internal/Unexpected defect gets a coverage ticket.
5. Close (5m): name the quadrant that keeps recurring.

THE MOVE

An Internal/Unexpected defect becomes a targeted test-coverage ticket that would have failed before the defect shipped.

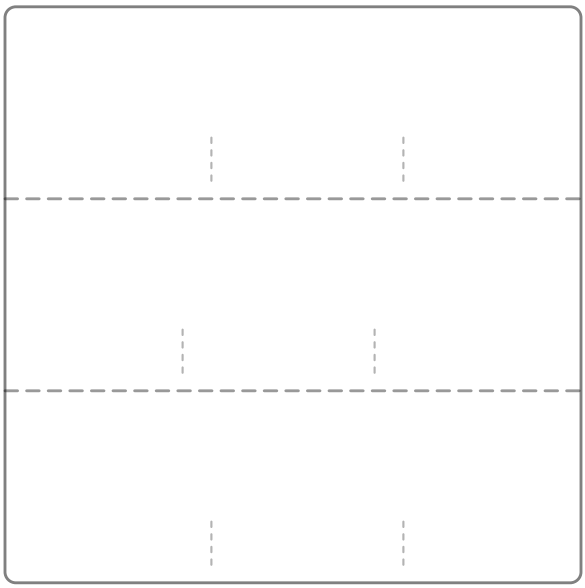
PROVENANCE

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The source names no originator.

Gary Klein's Pre-Mortem

3 Zones: Disaster Hall of Fame, Failure Generators, Immune System · 60–90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Project kick-offs, major architectural migrations, or high-stakes feature releases.

R28

Gary Klein's Pre-Mortem

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): recite the Prime Directive; fast-forward twelve months.
2. Gather data (15m): silently write how the migration failed catastrophically.
3. Generate insights (20m): group failure modes by theme; dot-vote two vectors.
4. Decide (15m): design safeguards against those vectors.
5. Close (5m): re-anchor; affirm collective ownership.

THE MOVE

Failure generators become mandatory architectural spikes: a load test at 2x peak traffic, owner and date.

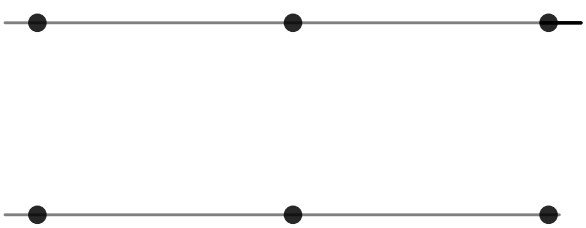
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the phases and minutes follow the written sequence in the source.

Source: Gary Klein (2007). *Performing a Project Premortem.* Harvard Business Review.

The Futurespective

3 Chronological Zones: Today, The Odyssey, The Promised Land · 90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Team formation, greenfield project kick-offs, or quarterly goal setting where the team must chart a path toward a defined future milestone.

R29

The Futurespective

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): state the Promised Land as a dated milestone.
2. Gather data (15m): list today's capabilities and technical debt.
3. Generate insights (30m): look back from success; place the Odyssey milestones.
4. Decide (25m): convert each milestone into an epic with a prerequisite.
5. Close (10m): name the first river to cross and its owner.

THE MOVE

Each Odyssey milestone becomes an epic-level deliverable with its infrastructure prerequisite named in the same ticket.

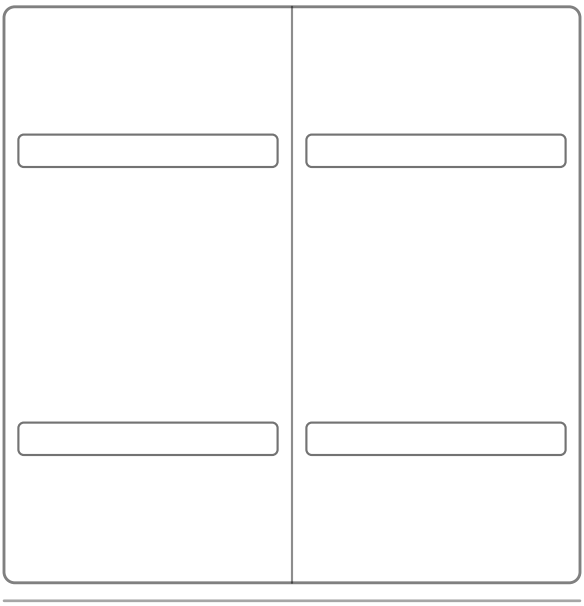
PROVENANCE

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The source names no originator.

Hopes & Fears

2 Polar Zones: Hopes (Opportunities) vs. Fears (Risks) · 45–60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

High-uncertainty environments, corporate acquisitions, sudden tech stack shifts, or major reorganizations.

R30

Hopes & Fears

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): explain anonymity; fears are risk data, not disloyalty.
2. Gather data (15m): write Hopes and Fears in two separate columns.
3. Generate insights (15m): review each Fear; label systemic risk or rumor.
4. Decide (10m): pair each systemic Fear with a mitigation experiment.
5. Close (5m): convert the Hopes into sprint objectives with owners.

THE MOVE

Every systemic Fear gets a paired mitigation experiment; every Hope becomes a measurable objective.

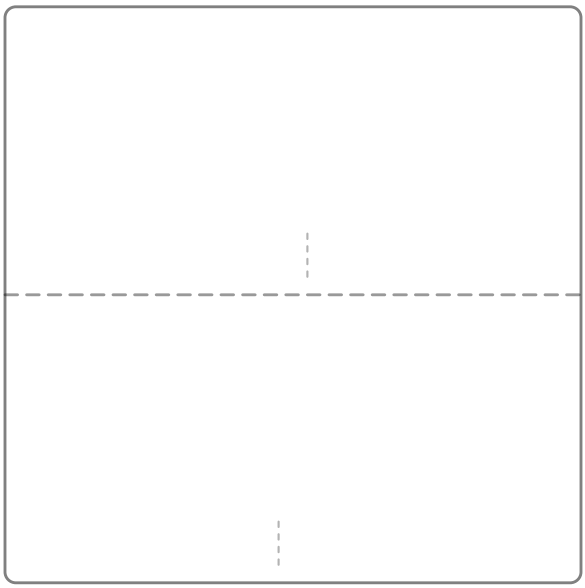
PROVENANCE

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Letter from the Future

2 Narrative Channels: Triumph Letter vs. Regret Letter · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Teams struggling to align on product vision, architectural consistency, or long-term operational health.

R31

Letter from the Future

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): read the Prime Directive; explain the two letters.
2. Gather data (15m): split into squads; draft triumph and regret letters.
3. Generate insights (20m): regroup; mark the decision inflection points.
4. Decide (15m): turn each inflection point into a governance check.
5. Close (5m): name the non-negotiable the team adopts first.

THE MOVE

An inflection point becomes an explicit governance check or technical non-negotiable, with an owner.

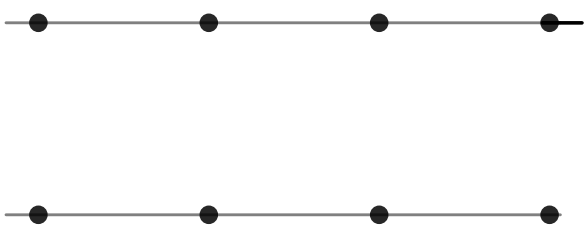
PROVENANCE

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Backcasting from Utopia

Reverse Timeline: Utopia (Year 3), Intermediates, Immediate Next Sprint · 90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Formulating multi-year engineering roadmaps, complex cloud migrations, or legacy system deprecation plans.

R32

Backcasting from Utopia

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): describe the Year 3 utopian architecture.
2. Gather data (20m): list today's constraints and legacy anchors.
3. Generate insights (30m): work backward; name each year's prerequisites.
4. Decide (20m): decompose the next sprint's immediate enablers.
5. Close (10m): assign the first prerequisite and its deadline.

THE MOVE

Immediate prerequisites become sprint backlog epics with a named owner and a date.

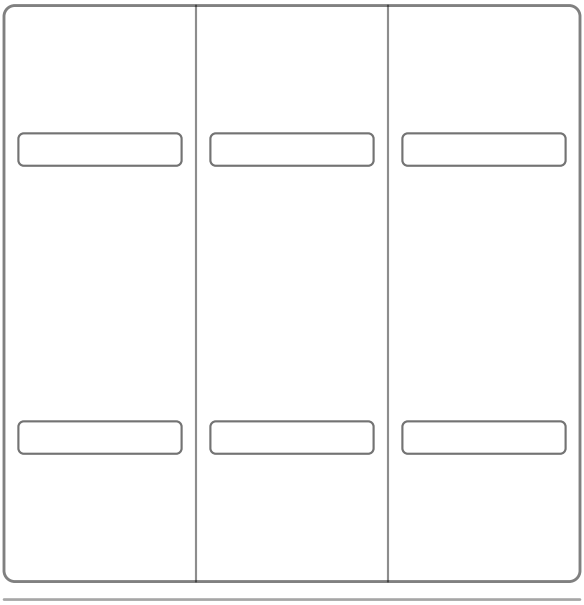
PROVENANCE

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The source names no originator.

Black Swan Stress-Test

3 Shock Scenarios: Cloud Outage, Core Maintainer Loss, Dependency Breach · 60–75 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Quarterly business continuity reviews, security posture hardening, or mission-critical launch readiness assessments.

R33

Black Swan Stress-Test

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): name the three shocks; survival is the goal.
2. Gather data (15m): map single points of failure.
3. Generate insights (20m): design a 10-minute survival protocol per shock.
4. Decide (10m): turn each single point into a cross-training pairing.
5. Close (5m): name the failover test to run first.

THE MOVE

Each single point of failure converts into a cross-training pairing, a secrets-rotation job, or a multi-region failover test.

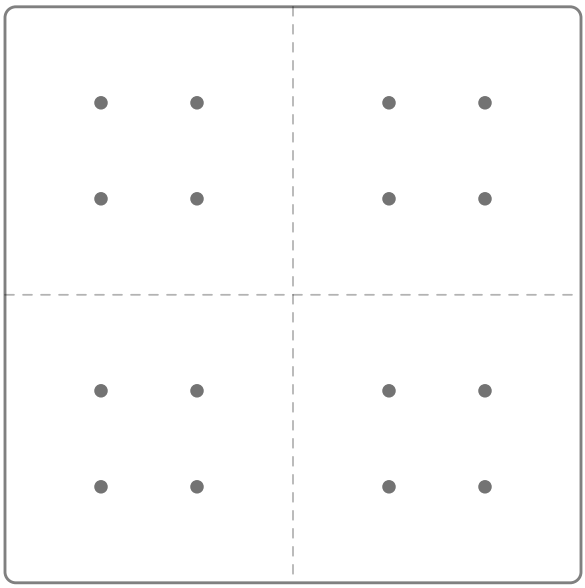
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

Source: Nassim Nicholas Taleb (2007). *The Black Swan: The Impact of the Highly Improbable.* Random House.

Front-Page Headline

Newspaper Grid: Headline, Sub-bullet, Metric Callout, Quote · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Inception phase of new products or major open-source modules; aligning cross-functional teams around end-user value.

R34

Front-Page Headline

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): show the blank front page and its four zones.
2. Gather data (15m): pairs draft a headline and a breakthrough metric.
3. Generate insights (20m): compare headlines; find the shared definition.
4. Decide (10m): choose the winning metric as the release Key Result.
5. Close (5m): publish the front page where the team can see it.

THE MOVE

The winning headline's metric becomes the release's formal Key Result, with a baseline.

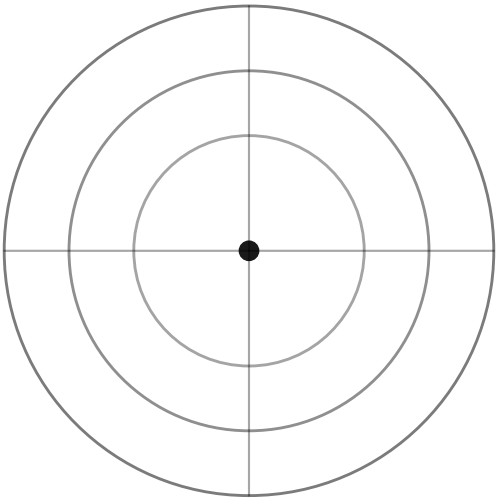
PROVENANCE

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The source names no originator.

Dynamic Risk Radar

3 Concentric Rings: High Priority, Emerging Risks, Weak Signals · 45–60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

High-velocity projects with complex external vendor, compliance, or infrastructure dependencies.

R35

Dynamic Risk Radar

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): draw four quadrants and three rings.
2. Gather data (15m): place every known risk on the radar.
3. Generate insights (15m): mark which risks are moving inward.
4. Decide (10m): assign mitigation spikes to the inner ring.
5. Close (5m): name the weak signal the team will watch next.

THE MOVE

Every inner-ring risk gets a mitigation spike scheduled in the next sprint, with an owner and a review date.

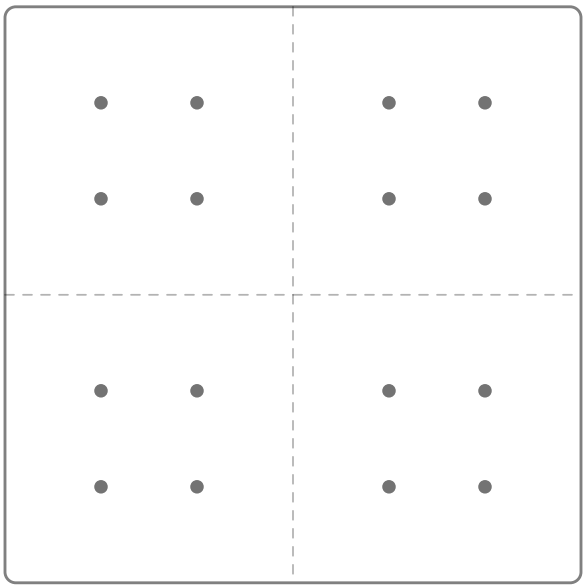
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Retro on Retros

4 Quadrants: Format, Psychological Safety, Action Velocity, Value · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Retrospective meetings have become stale, mechanical, or cynical; participants report low return on investment and action items are ignored.

R36

Retro on Retros

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): recite the Prime Directive; name past ceremony failures.
2. Gather data (15m): anonymously rate safety and action velocity, 1 to 5.
3. Generate insights (20m): find why retros stall; name the common antipatterns.
4. Decide (15m): redesign the cadence; rotation, frequency, WIP limits.
5. Close (5m): re-commit to collective continuous improvement.

THE MOVE

Actions reform the improvement process itself: rotate the facilitator and cap process tickets with a WIP limit.

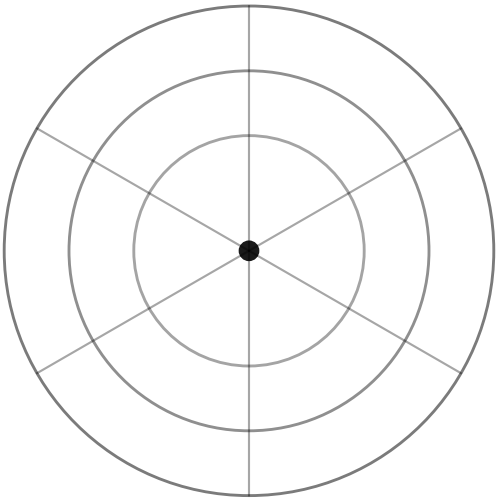
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the phases and minutes follow the written sequence in the source.

The source names no originator.

Team Health Radar

6 Dimensions: Code Health, Delivery, Fun, Safety, Autonomy, Speed · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Teams needing a holistic, multi-dimensional health assessment beyond velocity and bug counts.

R37

Team Health Radar

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): explain the six dimensions and the 1-to-5 scale.
2. Gather data (15m): anonymous poll on all six dimensions.
3. Generate insights (15m): plot the median; name the lowest and most split.
4. Decide (10m): pick the lowest dimension for a month-long initiative.
5. Close (10m): set the re-poll date and the owner.

THE MOVE

The lowest-scoring dimension becomes a focused improvement initiative for the upcoming month, with an owner and a re-poll date.

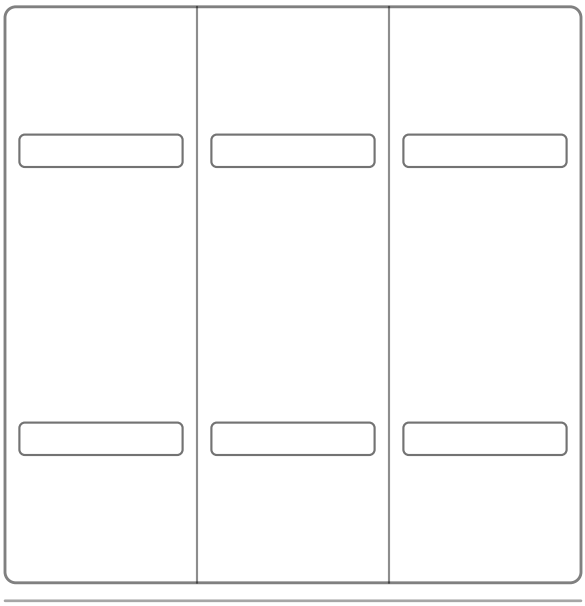
PROVENANCE

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The source names no originator.

Working Agreement Audit

3 Columns: Existing Agreement, Reality Check, Ratified Rules · 60–90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Broken team norms, recurring PR review bottlenecks, off-hours messaging, or boundary violations.

R38

Working Agreement Audit

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): list the agreements the team actually made.
2. Gather data (20m): mark where each agreement is followed or ignored.
3. Generate insights (25m): separate silent drift from rules that no longer work.
4. Decide (15m): drop, re-commit, or automate each agreement.
5. Close (10m): commit the revised agreements to the repository.

THE MOVE

Revised agreements land in /docs/working-agreements.md with automated enforcement where chosen.

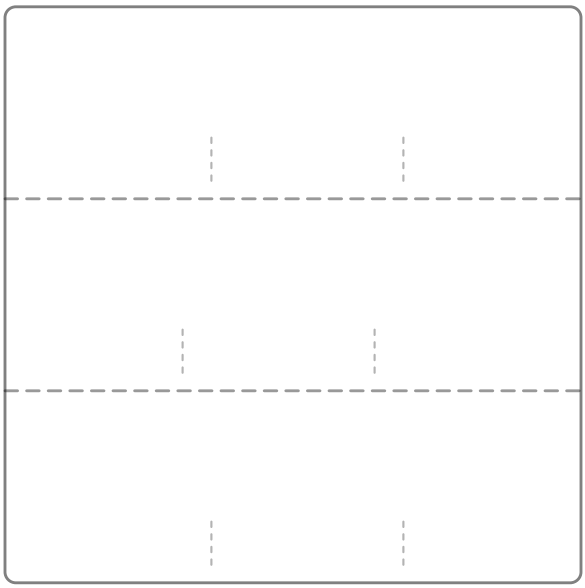
PROVENANCE

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Toxic Waste Dump

3 Sequestered Zones: Containment Trench, Decontamination, Clean Ground · 60–90 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Severe post-crunch burnout, organizational trauma, executive conflict, or high interpersonal frustration.

R39

Toxic Waste Dump

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): Prime Directive; containment rules; no personal attacks.
2. Gather data (20m): total silence; post frustrations into the Containment Trench.
3. Generate insights (25m): read notes without defence; sort reality from friction.
4. Decide (15m): pick exactly one systemic issue to neutralize.
5. Close (10m): shred the trench notes; confirm mutual support.

THE MOVE

Extracted friction becomes a protective barrier ticket: no-meeting Wednesdays for four weeks, with an owner.

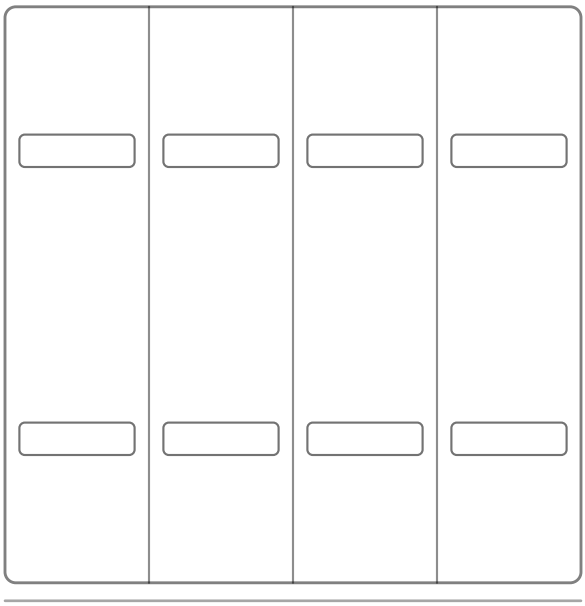
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the phases and minutes follow the written sequence in the source.

The source names no originator.

ESVP Safety Baseline

4 Anonymous Buckets: Explorer, Shopper, Vacationer, Prisoner · 15–20 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Noticeable disengagement, passive-aggressive silence, or when facilitating a newly formed team.

R40

ESVP Safety Baseline

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (3m): explain the four buckets.
2. Gather data (4m): silently pick Explorer, Shopper, Vacationer, or Prisoner.
3. Generate insights (5m): tally publicly; if Vacationers and Prisoners exceed half, pause.
4. Decide (5m): with low safety, switch to a root-cause session on autonomy.
5. Close (3m): name the one condition that would raise safety next time.

THE MOVE

If low safety is uncovered, the retro becomes a root-cause session on organizational autonomy, with a follow-up date.

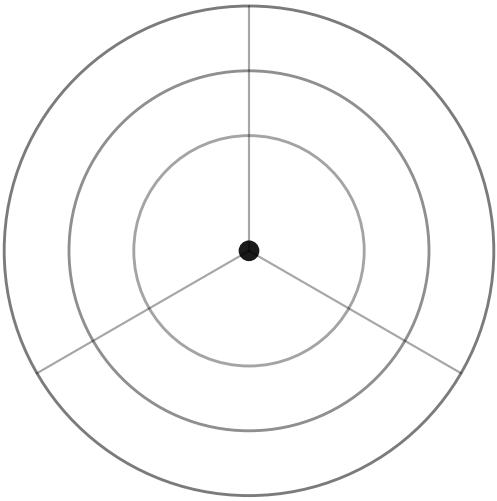
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

Source: Esther Derby & Diana Larsen (2006). *Agile Retrospectives.* Pragmatic Bookshelf.

Circles and Soup (CIA)

3 Concentric Circles: Control, Influence, The Soup · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Teams trapped in learned helplessness, complaining about executive decisions or external dependencies beyond their control.

R41

Circles and Soup (CIA)

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): draw the three circles.
2. Gather data (15m): write every complaint and challenge on a note.
3. Generate insights (15m): place each note; test the Soup items for influence.
4. Decide (10m): convert Control and Influence items into backlog tickets.
5. Close (10m): write adaptation protocols for what stays in The Soup.

THE MOVE

Only Control and Influence notes become backlog tickets; Soup notes generate internal resilience protocols.

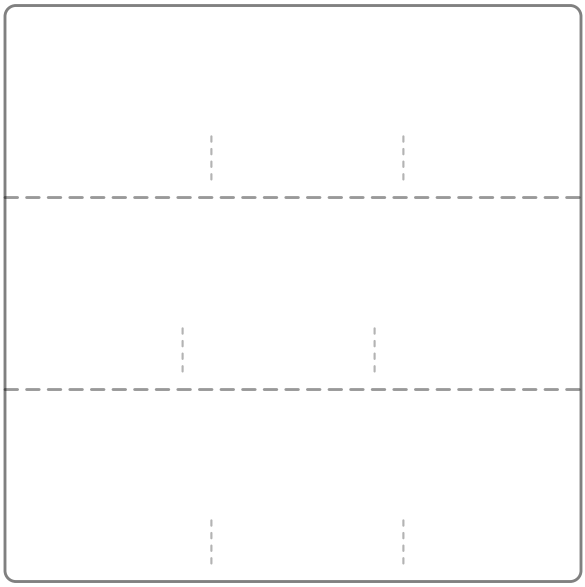
PROVENANCE

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Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2013). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

TRIZ (Destructive Innovation)

3 Phases: Maximum Sabotage, Brutal Reality, Firebreak Actions · 75 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Complacency, repeated missed sprint goals, or teams resistant to traditional process retrospectives.

R42

TRIZ (Destructive Innovation)

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): explain the joke; brainstorm how to guarantee failure.
2. Gather data (15m): list the worst practices in Phase 1.
3. Generate insights (25m): confront reality; tick what the team tolerates.
4. Decide (15m): turn each tick into a Stop Doing agreement.
5. Close (10m): name the first practice to stop this sprint.

THE MOVE

Checkmarked sabotage behaviors become explicit Stop Doing agreements with an owner and a start date.

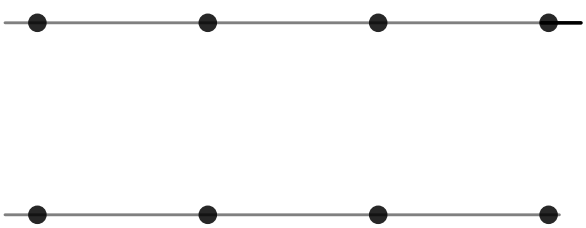
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

Source: Genrich Altshuller (1984). *Creativity as an Exact Science.* Gordon and Breach.
Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2013). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

1-2-4-All Systemic Sync

4 Sequential Workspaces: 1-min Solo, 2-min Pair, 4-min Quad, Plenary · 30–45 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Retrospectives dominated by senior engineers, architects, or managers, where junior and introverted team members remain silent.

R43

1-2-4-All Systemic Sync

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): pose the question; explain the four stages.
2. Gather data (10m): 1 minute solo, 2 minutes in pairs, 4 minutes in fours.
3. Generate insights (10m): harvest patterns; each group names its strongest idea.
4. Decide (10m): submit each group's insight to the Who-What-When converter.
5. Close (5m): read commitments; set the next review.

THE MOVE

Each group of four submits its highest-leverage insight as a dated commitment with a named owner.

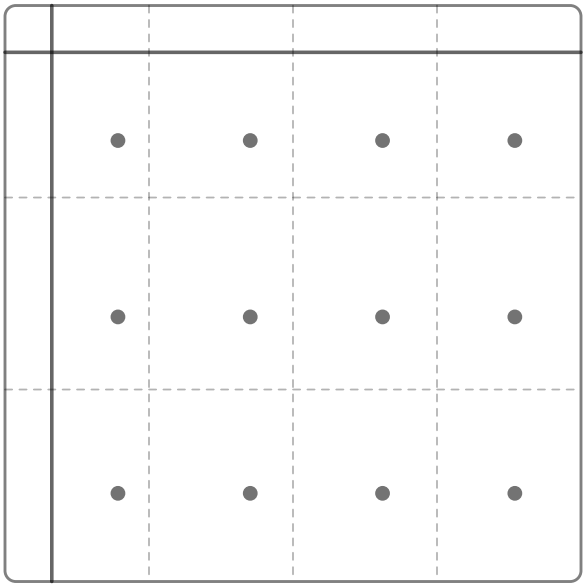
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2013). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

Appreciation Matrix & Kudos

Grid Layout: Core Peer Categories (Heroics, Glue-Work, Empathy, Mentorship) · 30–45 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Teams recovering from sustained deadlines, high-stress delivery cycles, or transactional working relationships.

R44

Appreciation Matrix & Kudos

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (5m): explain the four appreciation categories.
2. Gather data (10m): write at least two specific kudos to peers.
3. Generate insights (10m): read the notes aloud; name the repeated behaviours.
4. Decide (5m): copy the appreciations into the public channel.
5. Close (5m): commit to one recognition habit for the next sprint.

THE MOVE

Appreciations are copied into the organization's public channel, giving the work company-wide visibility.

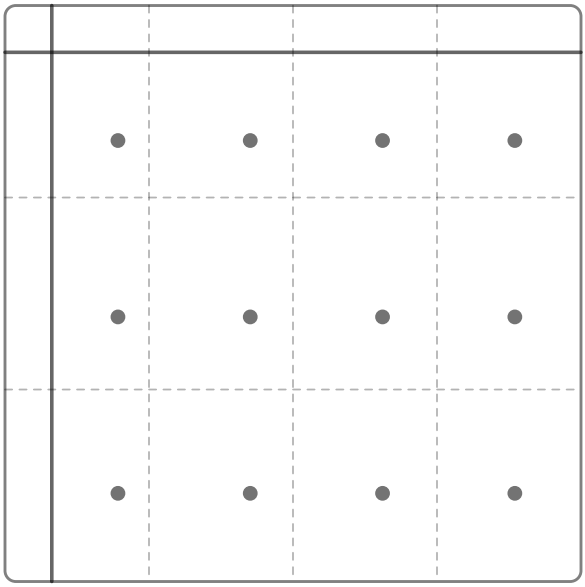
PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.

Role & Decision Matrix (D3)

3 Operational Tiers: Do, Discuss, Decide · 60 min



WHEN TO RUN IT

Friction over code reviews, ambiguous PR approvals, overlapping responsibilities, or micro-management disputes.

R45

Role & Decision Matrix (D3)

THE FIVE PHASES

1. Set the stage (10m): draw roles across, Do, Discuss and Decide down.
2. Gather data (15m): each role writes what others should Do, Discuss, Decide.
3. Generate insights (15m): compare perceptions with the actual role-holders.
4. Decide (10m): resolve each boundary mismatch into one owner.
5. Close (10m): export the consensus as the team decision governance doc.

THE MOVE

The resolved consensus is exported as a governance document and committed to the repository.

PROVENANCE

Source names the canvas and the intent and leaves the phases' wording and minutes to the facilitator.

The source names no originator.